



Zoo Explorers

Meet the Gorilla!

Critically Endangered

Facts • Colour • Activities

Gorilla Fact File ■

Scientific name:	Gorilla beringei / Gorilla gorilla
Status:	Critically Endangered
Where they live:	DR Congo, Uganda, Rwanda, Cameroon, Gabon
Habitat:	Tropical rainforests and mountain forests of Central Africa
Diet:	Herbivore — leaves, stems, fruit, bark, and roots
Weight:	135–220 kg (male), 70–90 kg (female)
Lifespan:	35–40 years in the wild
Population:	Fewer than 1,100 mountain gorillas remain

Amazing Facts ■

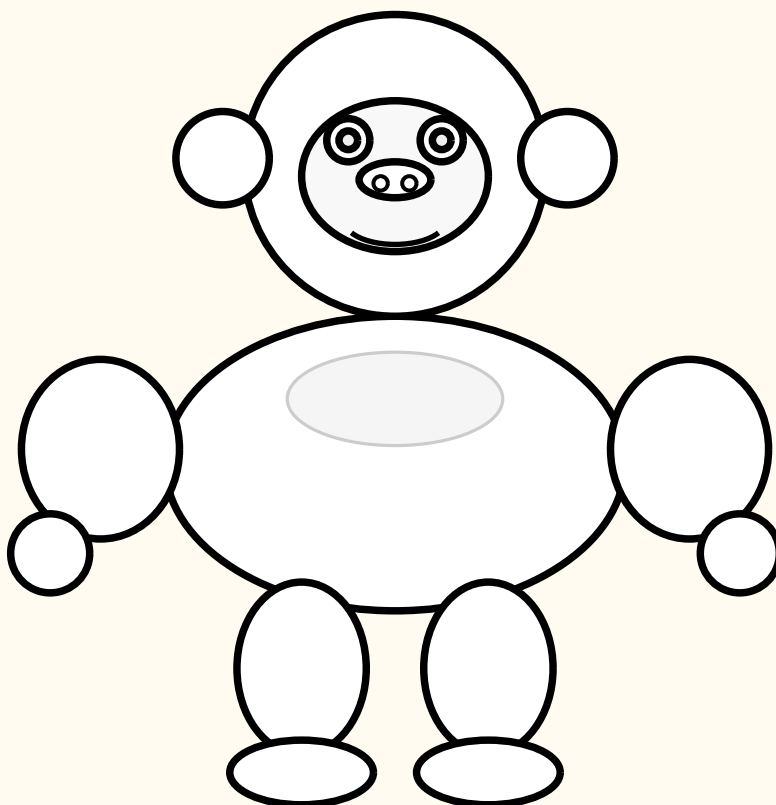
- Gorillas share 98.3% of their DNA with humans — our closest relatives after chimpanzees!
- A silverback's back hair turns silver-grey between ages 11 and 13.
- Gorillas build a brand new sleeping nest from branches every single night.
- Mountain gorillas wander a home range of up to 39 km² (15 square miles).
- Baby gorillas ride on their mother's back — just like a piggyback!
- Mountain gorilla numbers have actually increased with conservation — a rare success story!

Threats ■■

#	Threat	Impact
1	Habitat loss and deforestation	CRITICAL
2	Poaching	HIGH
3	Disease (including human respiratory illnesses)	HIGH
4	Civil conflict in their range countries	MODERATE

Colour Me! — Gorilla

Gorillas have black fur. Adult male silverbacks have a grey or silver patch on their back, which appears as they mature.



Activities ➡

Word Search — find all 8 words!

C	O	N	S	E	R	V	A	T	I	O	N
V	P	E	G	A	Y	A	Q	L	K	P	A
Y	R	A	I	N	F	O	R	E	S	T	E
Y	Y	G	P	P	Z	R	Z	O	G	U	K
Q	M	J	D	R	C	I	I	R	L	W	Y
G	O	R	I	L	L	A	Q	C	M	J	M
A	P	Z	Y	H	A	B	I	T	A	T	W
Z	O	C	T	G	B	W	S	A	I	H	G
A	M	S	I	L	V	E	R	B	A	C	K
N	A	V	T	K	W	R	Y	O	I	Y	Y
Q	D	L	P	R	I	M	A	T	E	T	B
M	B	E	N	D	A	N	G	E	R	E	D

GORILLA	SILVERBACK	RAINFOREST	ENDANGERED
AFRICA	PRIMATE	HABITAT	CONSERVATION

Match It Up!

Gorilla		eats leaves and fruit
Silverback		rides on mum's back
Baby gorilla		where gorillas live
Rainforest		leader of the gorilla troop
Poaching		a danger to gorillas

Fill in the Blanks!

- Gorillas live in _____ in Central Africa.
- A male gorilla leader is called a _____.
- Gorillas share ____% of their DNA with humans.
- Mountain gorillas are _____ Endangered.

Answers: rainforests | Silverback | 98.3 | Critically

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